

You show that you have understood the text. The operator that is used in the task tells you what is expected in your answer:

operator	What is expected	example
describe	You write in detail about what sb. or sth. is like.	<i>Describe the situation Ethan is in and how he deals with it.</i>
summarise	You write about the main aspects of sth. or about somebody's behaviour.	<i>Summarise what Ethan finds out about Touchstone and how this changes his feelings.</i>
point out	You write about certain aspects and explain them.	<i>Point out the aspects that prove that Touchstone is not what Ethan thought.</i>

Dos 	Before writing: ○ Read the text carefully and highlight key words and/or key sentences. ○ It can be helpful to divide the texts up in parts or subsections and find an appropriate sentence or keywords to summarise each section. Writing an introduction: The introductory sentence of your summary should include the author, title, type of text, the place and date of publication, and the main idea. In other words, you need to answer the wh-questions: • Who is the author? • When was the text published? • Where was it published? • What type of text is it? • What topic does the text deal with? State the underlying problem or conflict, and not simply its content. Writing the main part: The main part of your summary connects the highlighted passages and the summaries or key words of the subsections. ○ Focus on the essentials / on basic facts. ○ Use the present tense. ○ Use your own words. ○ Use formal language. ○ Use connectives to link your sentences.
	Don'ts  - X Don't include irrelevant details. - X Don't use the present progressive. - X Don't use quotations or direct speech. - X Don't give your personal opinion. - X Don't start analysing the text. - X Don't try to create suspense.

Language support:

Introduction: • <i>The short story/novel/article/poem... "[title]" ...</i> • <i>The extract from the short story / novel /... "[title]" by [author]...</i> • <i>...written by [author] in [year]...</i> • <i>... written by [author] and published in [source] in [year]...</i> • <i>... deals with/is about/shows/illustrates...</i>	Stating the topic/purpose of a text: <i>The article/story... is about /shows /presents/ depicts/alludes to/refers to /criticizes/ targets/ comments on... the fact that/the problem of...</i> Main part: • <i>According to the author,</i> • <i>The author believes / claims / emphasizes / states / points out...</i> • <i>From the author's point of view,...</i> • <i>The author is of the opinion that...</i>
--	---

1 Writing exercise: Food for a week

In a future world, the authorities are trying to capture Indigenous Canadians. The narrator, Frenchie, and a group of other Indigenous people are hiding from them in the wilderness and cannot stay in the same place for long. One day Frenchie comes face to face with a moose.

I aimed the gun¹, watching the trees, praying² for nothing more than a deer³, nothing human, really.

It was huge, like a tree had yanked itself up
5 and was slowly moving into the clearing, a tree with bone white branches.

It walked further into the grass. A moose. I'd never seen one this close before. Adrenaline made my teeth chatter.

10 Time is slow in that vacuum space. In this new space, I had time to aim squarely between the moose's eyes. Then I decided against it, lowering the barrel to his chest⁴: always go for the sure target. Miig had taught us that on one
15 of my first hunts, and I listen to my Elders.

Just then he raised his head, so massive I wondered at the blood it must take to animate, and he saw me. He blinked⁵ a long, slow blink and faltered for only a second or two before he began chewing⁶ again. He turned a bit so that I knew he knew I was there. I swallowed hard, aiming, fingers exact and stiff. He was so big. It was like he was a hundred years old, like he had watched
20 all of this happen. Imagine being here through it all – the wars, the sickness, the earthquakes, the schools – only to come to this?

He exhaled, long and loud like the wind. This was food for a week. This was me, the conquering hero, marching into camp with more meat than all of us could carry. This was Rose looking at me with those big eyes so dark they shone burgundy in the firelight. This was my chance.

25 But could we travel with this meat before it rotted⁷? No. And could we smoke and dry it? No, Miig wouldn't set up camp for that long, especially not with a steady thread of smoke reaching above the trees, blasting a signal to anyone who might be out there. So we'd be leaving half, at least half, behind to rot.

The moose watched all this play out on my face, a dirty boy tangled in the roots of an upended
30 tree. And he stayed perfectly still. His eyes were huge, dark globes that reflected back their surroundings. I was sure I could see myself in there, in the trees, a long-haired warrior taking aim.

I lowered the rifle. He blinked once more, then crossed his legs, one over the other as if at the start of a curtsey then turned back into the trees.

I couldn't do it. I couldn't let it come to this, not for him and not for me.

35 Walking back to the meeting point, I swung between peace with my decision and wrenching regret. I was empty-handed, but something in my chest was burning a little brighter. I was okay with my decision, but not okay with the consequences. I secretly hoped no one else had gotten anything so I wouldn't be the only loser, even if it meant we went hungry for a day. I pictured RiRi's face, sad because of an empty belly. That made me ashamed.



From: Cherie Dimaline *Marrow Thieves* (abridged)

1 gun object used to shoot animals and people ○ 2 to pray here: to hope for sth very much ○ 3 deer four-legged brown animal that lives in groups in the woods and is frequently hunted ○ 4 chest part of the body where the heart is ○ 5 to blink to open and close one's eyes quickly ○ 6 to chew to break food into smaller pieces with your teeth ○ 7 to rot here: process of food going bad and becoming unfit to eat

Comprehension task:

Describe the situation Frenchie finds himself in and how he deals with it.